

ID: SOMA-M-P12

Title: Tuning in to Sounds

Duration: 10m 00s (738 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore this practice of tuning in to sounds. Wherever you are right now, sounds are a part of your environment. Some sounds may be clearer and easier to notice, while others may be faint and in the background. Often, we hear without paying much attention, or we notice sounds only when they feel distracting or unpleasant.

You do not need silence for this practice. You may not even need quiet. In fact, the busyness of everyday life offers many opportunities for tuning in. You may be indoors or outdoors, seated, walking, or in the middle of a task. Wherever you are, this practice can accompany you. Please ensure that the environment you are in is safe.

Now, take a moment to settle where you are. Notice how your body is positioned. You may feel your feet on the ground, your back supported, or your hands resting. There is no need to change anything in your experience. Allow yourself to arrive with your senses in the present moment.

When you're ready, begin by noticing the presence of sound around you. Without straining your ears, allow yourself to be open to whatever sound is here. Sounds may come from near or far, from outside your space, or within it.

You might start with what feels most noticeable. Perhaps a voice, a hum from a machine or device, someone walking, the movement of air. Allow your attention to rest here for a few moments, attending to qualities such as loudness, softness, rhythm, or tone.

[Short Pause] (10s - Initial sound layer)

If focusing on one sound feels difficult, you can let your attention rest lightly, as if floating from one sound to another. You do not need to hold your focus on anything in particular. The practice is about noticing what is present, without needing to hold on to what you are noticing.

[Long Pause] (20s - Floating awareness)

Now, gently expanding your awareness to notice if there are any sounds in the background. Some of these sounds may be faint but steady, like a clock ticking, or distant traffic. Other sounds may appear and disappear quickly. Allow them all to be a part of your soundscape.

[Short Pause] (10s - Background focus)

Let sounds be as they are, even if they feel distracting, unexpected, or unpleasant. If a sound is sudden or harsh, notice any reaction – perhaps your body tenses up momentarily, or your mind resists. See if you can meet the sound and the experience with openness, acknowledging its presence without pushing it away.

[Long Pause] (20s - Accepting difficult sounds)

A sound may also feel pleasant, like a bird song or gentle music. Notice that as well, if it arises. Acknowledge how the body responds – perhaps with warmth, ease, or calm. Allow the presence of these sounds without needing to hold on to them or make them last longer.

You may become aware of emotions arising with sounds. Perhaps a sound brings a feeling of joy, curiosity, or discomfort. All of these responses are natural. Acknowledge them, and let them be part of your experience without needing to fix or change them.

[Long Pause] (20s - Emotional resonance)

At times you may notice several sounds at once. You may choose to focus on one, or allow them to be together.

If your attention wanders into thoughts or emotions, this is normal. When you notice the mind drifting, patiently bring your attention back to the sounds around you. You may choose whichever sound feels easiest to connect with in this moment.

[Short Pause] (10s - Re-centering)

You may notice that some sounds are more readily received than others. Perhaps louder sounds feel closer, and softer ones more distant. Allow your attention to adjust naturally, without forcing it. Your ears will pick up what they are ready to notice in this moment.

There may also be moments of silence or quiet spaces between sounds. Allow these pauses to also be a part of the soundscape.

[Long Pause] (20s - Space between sounds)

Sometimes, the sounds of your own body may come into your awareness. You might hear your breath or your stomach rumbling. You might hear your clothes rustling or your footsteps. Allow these inner sounds to be part of what you hear.

Notice the difference between sounds inside you and sounds outside. Simply observe how your attention shifts back and forth.

[Short Pause] (10s - Inner/Outer sounds)

Spend a few more moments tuning in to sounds, allowing sounds to come and go in your awareness.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Allow this practice to come to a close when you are ready. Take a deep breath, if you like.

Thank you for your practice.

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